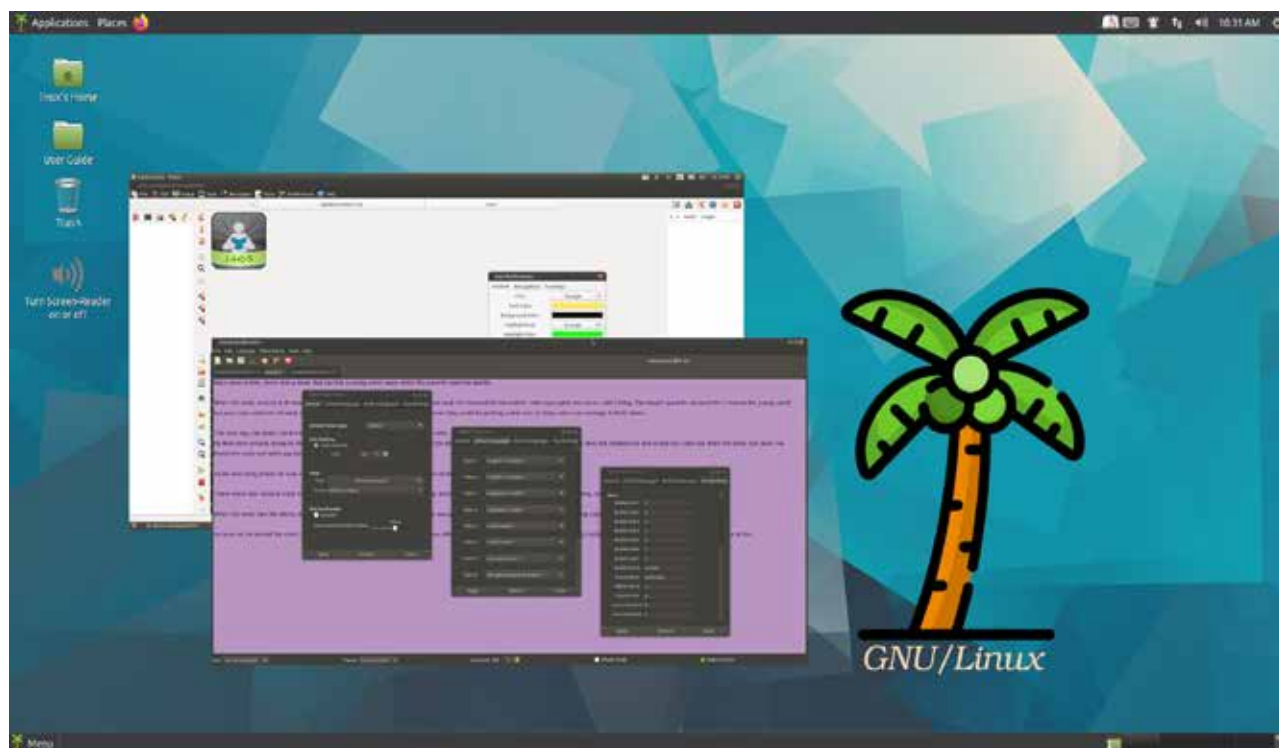


Zendalona: Enabling Accessibility and Inclusivity for the Visually Impaired

Zendalona's open source software are designed to empower the visually impaired community through innovative solutions.



Zendalona, an organisation focused on FOSS for the visually impaired, is a brainchild of K. Sathyaseelan. At a tender age of 10, Sathyaseelan lost his vision to an accident and often found himself challenged by the lack of infrastructure for screen readers and limited availability of Braille reading material. Sometimes he would sit in a library full of books with only the ability to absorb the scent of the books and not the knowledge. All these and other

experiences over his career as a lifelong teacher led to the creation of Zendalona for developing open source products customised to the needs of the visually challenged community.

The Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) movement is more than a development methodology; it is a philosophy that values transparency, collaboration, and community empowerment. By making code and tools openly accessible, FOSS has reshaped the technological

landscape, empowering individuals and communities to innovate and solve problems collectively. It has lowered barriers to entry, allowing diverse contributors to enhance existing systems and create solutions tailored to specific needs.

For visually impaired individuals, access to technology can be a significant challenge. This is where Zendalona steps in. By embracing the principles of FOSS, Zendalona is not only addressing these challenges but